

Unit 5

Developing Successful Business Ideas

3 Slibraries · 15 framework sheets

SLIBRARY 13 Jobs-to-Be-Done

5 sheets

- | | |
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| 1 JTBD Canvas | 4 Switch Interview · 4 Forces |
| 2 Outcome-Driven Innovation | 5 Job Map |
| 3 Progress Made Easier | |

SLIBRARY 14 Lean Canvas

5 sheets

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|--------------------------|-------------------|
| 1 Lean Canvas (9 Blocks) | 4 Lean Stack |
| 2 Problem-Solution Fit | 5 Traction Canvas |
| 3 Product-Market Fit | |

SLIBRARY 15 MVP & Kano Ladder

5 sheets

- | | |
|-----------------------|----------------------------|
| 1 Kano Model | 4 Riskiest Assumption Test |
| 2 MVP Ladder | 5 Prototyping |
| 3 Build-Measure-Learn | |

JTBD Canvas

SLIBRARY 13 · SHEET 1 / 5

Job Executor · Functional · Emotional · Social · Context

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The JTBD Canvas operationalises Christensen's Jobs-to-be-Done lens onto a single sheet covering five elements: the Job Executor (who does the hiring), the Functional Job (what is the practical task), the Emotional Job (how do they want to feel), the Social Job (how do they want to be seen), and the Context (the conditions surrounding the hire). Mapping all five forces the team past surface features to the actual job customers hire products to do (Christensen et al., 2016; Klement, 2018).

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Synthesised from Clayton Christensen, Taddy Hall, Karen Dillon and David Duncan's *Competing Against Luck* (2016) and operationalised as a canvas form by Alan Klement in *When Coffee and Kale Compete* (2018) and the Strategyzer team (2017).

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Demographic and psychographic segmentation explained who customers were but not why they hired products. Christensen argued — backed by hundreds of innovation case studies — that the unit of analysis should be the job, not the customer. The canvas made the JTBD lens workshop-actionable.

HOW IT IS USED

Conduct switch interviews with recent buyers. For each job uncovered, populate the five canvas elements. Use the canvas to test whether new offers address the actual job (not just adjacent functional features).

WHEN IT IS USED

Use in product-discovery research, in segment definition, in B2B account planning, and as a lens for evaluating whether a roadmap addresses real customer jobs or merely feature-parity demands.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Product managers, marketing strategists, B2B account managers, and innovation teams designing offers that compete on job-completion, not feature-list.

FIGURE 1 · FIVE JOB ELEMENTS

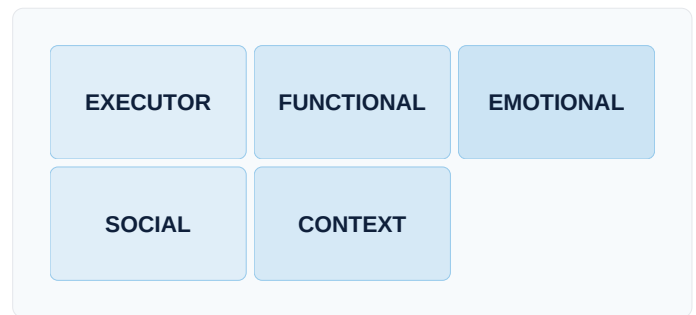


Figure 1. Five elements decompose the job; functional features alone are necessary but never sufficient.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Where Cooper (1999) personified users and Osterwalder (2014) mapped jobs/pains/gains in the VPC, the JTBD Canvas's contribution is the explicit five-element decomposition that separates functional, emotional and social dimensions. Building on Levitt's (1960) marketing-myopia critique, it gives JTBD operational specificity.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

Outcome-Driven Innovation · Slibrary 13

Switch Interview · 4 Forces · Slibrary 13

Value Proposition Canvas · Slibrary 9

Job Map · Slibrary 13

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Christensen, C.M., Hall, T., Dillon, K. and Duncan, D.S. (2016) *Competing Against Luck*. New York: HarperBusiness.
 Klement, A. (2018) *When Coffee and Kale Compete*. Self-published.
 Christensen, C.M., Cook, S. and Hall, T. (2005) 'Marketing Malpractice', *Harvard Business Review*, 83(12), pp. 74–83.
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Outcome-Driven Innovation

SLIBRARY 13 · SHEET 2 / 5

Customers hire products to achieve outcomes, not features

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

Anthony Ulwick's Outcome-Driven Innovation (ODI) operationalises Jobs-to-be-Done with quantitative rigour: customers articulate desired *outcomes* from the job in standardised statements ("Minimise the time it takes to..."), each outcome is rated for importance and current satisfaction, and the gap (importance minus satisfaction) identifies under-served outcomes — the highest-leverage targets for innovation. ODI replaces feature-request gathering with outcome-statement analysis (Ulwick, 2005, 2016).

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Anthony W. Ulwick, founder of Strategyn, in his 2005 book *What Customers Want* and refined in *Jobs to Be Done: Theory to Practice* (2016). Built on his 1990s consulting work with Cordis, Bosch and Microsoft.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Voice-of-the-customer research collected feature requests that were unreliable predictors of innovation success because customers asked for incremental versions of what they had. Ulwick reframed VoC as outcome-statement analysis — what they want to *achieve* — replacing feature roadmaps with outcome priorities.

HOW IT IS USED

Interview customers using the ODI outcome-statement format. Quantitatively rate importance × satisfaction on a sample. Compute opportunity scores; the highest-gap outcomes are the innovation targets. Design solutions against those outcomes, not against feature requests.

WHEN IT IS USED

Use in B2B and high-value B2C research, in product-strategy reviews, in market-segmentation refinement, and as a quantitative complement to qualitative JTBD research.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

B2B product managers, market researchers, and consulting teams advising on product-innovation portfolios. Used extensively by Bosch, Microsoft, Pratt & Whitney and other engineering-led firms.

FIGURE 1 · OPPORTUNITY SCORE

Outcome	Imp.	Sat.	Score
Reduce setup time	9	4	14
Avoid errors	8	5	11
Lower cost	7	6	8
Look modern	5	5	5

Figure 1. Score = Importance + max(Importance – Satisfaction, 0). The highest scores are innovation priorities. Adapted from Ulwick (2005).

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Where Christensen et al.'s (2016) JTBD was qualitative and Kano's (1984) needs taxonomy used categorical buckets, Ulwick's contribution is the quantitative outcome-statement methodology with measurable opportunity scores. Building on Akao's (1990) QFD tradition, it makes JTBD numerically rigorous.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

JTBD Canvas · Slibrary 13

Switch Interview · 4 Forces · Slibrary 13

Job Map · Slibrary 13

Kano Model · Slibrary 15

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Ulwick, A.W. (2005) *What Customers Want*. New York: McGraw-Hill.

Ulwick, A.W. (2016) *Jobs to Be Done: Theory to Practice*. Idea Bite Press.

Christensen, C.M., Hall, T., Dillon, K. and Duncan, D.S. (2016) *Competing Against Luck*. New York: HarperBusiness.

Kano, N. (1984) 'Attractive Quality and Must-Be Quality', *Journal of the Japanese Society for Quality Control*, 14(2), pp. 39–48.

Progress Made Easier

SLIBRARY 13 · SHEET 3 / 5

Remove obstacles that block progress, don't add features

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The Progress Made Easier framing (Bob Moesta and Chris Spiek) reframes products as instruments for customer progress: customers are not passive feature-buyers but active progress-makers, and the product's role is to remove obstacles to progress rather than add features. The shift moves the design conversation from "what features should we add?" to "what is blocking customers from making the progress they're already trying to make?" — usually a sharper, smaller intervention (Moesta and Spiek, 2020).

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Bob Moesta and Chris Spiek of the ReWired Group, building on a decade of partnership with Clayton Christensen at the Christensen Institute. Codified in Moesta's *Demand-Side Sales 101* (2020) and the JTBD methodology Moesta has practised since the 1990s.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Standard product roadmaps were dominated by feature additions even when usage data showed customers struggling with existing features. Moesta argued the conventional frame mis-located the problem: the customer's job is making progress, and the obstacle to progress is what to design against — usually subtractive, not additive.

HOW IT IS USED

Identify the progress the customer is trying to make. Map obstacles in their current path. Design interventions that remove obstacles rather than add capabilities. Test whether progress is now easier — not whether more features are present.

WHEN IT IS USED

Use in product-strategy reviews where roadmaps default to additive thinking, in onboarding redesign, in checkout-funnel optimisation, and whenever the product is bloated relative to demonstrated user struggle.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Product managers, UX researchers, growth teams, and B2B customer-success leaders. Increasingly used in healthcare and financial services where progress is non-trivial.

FIGURE 1 · PROGRESS PATH



Figure 1. The product's role is to remove the obstacle, not add to either side. Progress is the metric.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Where Christensen's (2016) JTBD framed the customer's job and Ulwick's (2005) ODI quantified outcomes, Moesta's contribution is the prescriptive design move — remove obstacles rather than add features. Building on Lewin's (1947) force-field analysis, it gives JTBD a subtractive operating principle.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

[JTBD Canvas · Slibrary 13](#)
[Switch Interview · 4 Forces · Slibrary 13](#)
[Job Map · Slibrary 13](#)
[Outcome-Driven Innovation · Slibrary 13](#)

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

- Moesta, B. (2020) *Demand-Side Sales 101*. Lioncrest Publishing.
- Christensen, C.M., Hall, T., Dillon, K. and Duncan, D.S. (2016) *Competing Against Luck*. New York: HarperBusiness.
- Spiek, C. and Moesta, B. (2014) *The Jobs-to-Be-Done Handbook*. ReWired Group.
- Lewin, K. (1947) 'Frontiers in Group Dynamics', *Human Relations*, 1(1), pp. 5–41.

Switch Interview · 4 Forces

SLIBRARY 13 · SHEET 4 / 5

Push of current · Pull of new · Anxiety · Habit — four forces around any switch

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The Switch Interview is a JTBD research method that reconstructs a recent purchase decision as a balance of four forces: *Push* (problems with the current solution), *Pull* (attraction of the new solution), *Anxiety* (concerns about the new solution), and *Habit* (inertia of the current behaviour). The customer switches when $\text{Push} + \text{Pull} > \text{Anxiety} + \text{Habit}$. Decomposing each force gives product teams precise levers — reduce anxiety, sharpen pull, exploit push moments (Christensen et al., 2016).

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Bob Moesta and Chris Spiek (ReWired Group) developed switch interviews through hundreds of customer interviews in the 1990s–2000s; Christensen, Hall, Dillon and Duncan codified the methodology in *Competing Against Luck* (2016).

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Standard customer interviews asked about feature preferences in the abstract — answers were unreliable predictors of switching behaviour. Moesta's switch-interview discipline focused on a specific recent switch, eliciting the concrete forces that produced it, replacing self-reported preferences with reconstructed behaviour.

HOW IT IS USED

Recruit customers who switched recently. Interview about the timeline: when did you first realise the old solution wasn't working? When did you start considering alternatives? What worried you about switching? Decompose into the four forces.

WHEN IT IS USED

Use in early product discovery, in B2B sales-process design, in churn-cause investigation, and when redesigning marketing messaging to address specific anxieties or sharpen pull.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Product researchers, growth teams, B2B sales leadership, and content marketers designing switch-supporting collateral.

FIGURE 1 · FOUR SWITCHING FORCES

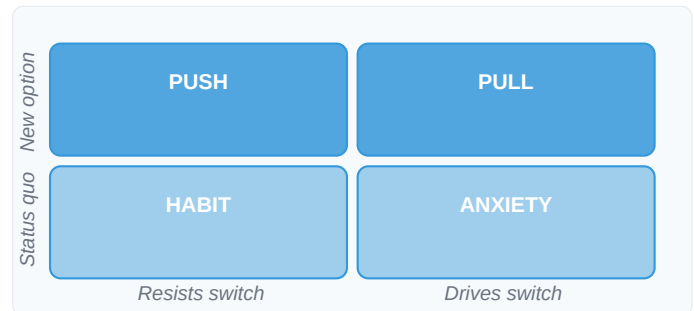


Figure 1. Switch happens when $\text{Push} + \text{Pull} > \text{Anxiety} + \text{Habit}$. Each force is a precise lever for design.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Where traditional VoC interviews (Akao, 1990) elicited feature preferences and stated-preference techniques (Cattin and Wittink, 1982) used hypothetical trade-offs, Moesta's contribution is the timeline-reconstruction method that surfaces actual forces. Building on protocol-analysis tradition (Ericsson and Simon, 1980), it makes switch-causation auditable.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

[JTBD Canvas · Slibrary 13](#)
[Outcome-Driven Innovation · Slibrary 13](#)
[Discovery Interviews · Slibrary 16](#)
[Pivot Types · Slibrary 16](#)

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Christensen, C.M., Hall, T., Dillon, K. and Duncan, D.S. (2016) *Competing Against Luck*. New York: HarperBusiness.
 Moesta, B. and Spiek, C. (2014) *The Jobs-to-Be-Done Handbook*. ReWired Group.
 Klement, A. (2018) *When Coffee and Kale Compete*. Self-published.
 Ericsson, K.A. and Simon, H.A. (1980) 'Verbal Reports as Data', *Psychological Review*, 87(3), pp. 215–251.

Job Map

SLIBRARY 13 · SHEET 5 / 5

Define · Locate · Prepare · Confirm · Execute · Monitor · Modify · Conclude

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

Lance Bettencourt and Anthony Ulwick's Job Map decomposes any job into eight universal steps: Define, Locate, Prepare, Confirm, Execute, Monitor, Modify, Conclude. Mapping a job along these steps surfaces hidden inefficiencies — friction, waiting, errors — at every stage, not just the execution moment that products typically focus on. The map exposes high-opportunity steps before, around and after execution that competitors are systematically ignoring (Bettencourt and Ulwick, 2008).

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Lance Bettencourt and Anthony Ulwick, in their 2008 *Harvard Business Review* article "The Customer-Centered Innovation Map". Built on Strategyn's twenty years of practice with Cordis, Bosch and similar engineering-led innovators.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Product teams optimised the execution step (the moment of product use) and ignored the surrounding steps where most customer time, friction and error occurred. The Job Map's eight-step decomposition surfaced these neglected stages as innovation targets.

HOW IT IS USED

Map the job along the eight steps. For each step, identify what the customer is trying to accomplish and what gets in the way. Most innovation opportunities live in steps competitors ignore — typically Define, Prepare, Monitor or Conclude.

WHEN IT IS USED

Use in B2B service-design research, in product-architecture reviews, in onboarding-flow design, and in identifying expansion-product opportunities adjacent to a core offer.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

B2B product managers, service-design researchers, customer-success leaders, and consultants conducting white-space innovation analysis.

FIGURE 1 · EIGHT JOB STEPS

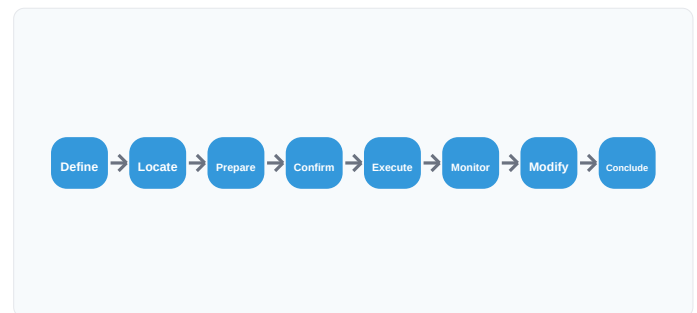


Figure 1. Eight universal steps; most innovation opportunities live in steps competitors ignore. Adapted from Bettencourt & Ulwick (2008).

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Where Shostack's (1984) service blueprint mapped operational steps and Stickdorn's (2018) customer-journey mapped emotional steps, Bettencourt and Ulwick's contribution is the universal eight-step job decomposition that applies across industries. Building on Womack and Jones's (1996) value-stream mapping, it gives innovation a step-level diagnostic.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

JTBD Canvas · Slibary 13

Outcome-Driven Innovation · Slibary 13

Customer Journey Map · Slibary 3

Progress Made Easier · Slibary 13

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Bettencourt, L.A. and Ulwick, A.W. (2008) 'The Customer-Centered Innovation Map', *Harvard Business Review*, 86(5), pp. 109–114.
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 Bettencourt, L.A. (2010) *Service Innovation*. New York: McGraw-Hill.
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Lean Canvas (9 Blocks)

SLIBRARY 14 · SHEET 1 / 5

Problem · Solution · UVP · Advantage · Customers · Channels · Revenue · Cost · Metrics

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

Ash Maurya's Lean Canvas is a Lean Startup-adapted replacement for Osterwalder's BMC, redesigned for early-stage ventures where uncertainty dominates. Four blocks are replaced: Key Partners → Problem, Key Activities → Solution, Key Resources → Key Metrics, Customer Relationships → Unfair Advantage. The substitutions emphasise problem validation and traction over operational optimisation — fitting the questions startups actually face before product-market fit (Maurya, 2012).

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Ash Maurya, founder and serial entrepreneur, in his 2012 book *Running Lean*. Built on Osterwalder and Pigneur's (2010) BMC and Eric Ries's (2011) Lean Startup methodology, addressing the BMC's perceived weaknesses for early-stage ventures.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

BMC users at the venture stage routinely populated Key Partners and Key Activities with speculation because partnerships and activities had not yet emerged. Maurya replaced these with Problem and Solution blocks — what early ventures actually needed to test.

HOW IT IS USED

Populate all nine blocks using available evidence. Test problem-solution fit before scaling solution-channel fit. Iterate the canvas weekly during early-stage learning. The canvas is a hypothesis artefact, not a plan.

WHEN IT IS USED

Use in venture inception, in accelerator programmes, in pre-funding pitch preparation, and in MBA entrepreneurship courses where students design ventures from scratch.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Early-stage founders, accelerator coaches, MBA entrepreneurship instructors, and venture-design facilitators in incubator settings.

FIGURE 1 · NINE LEAN BLOCKS

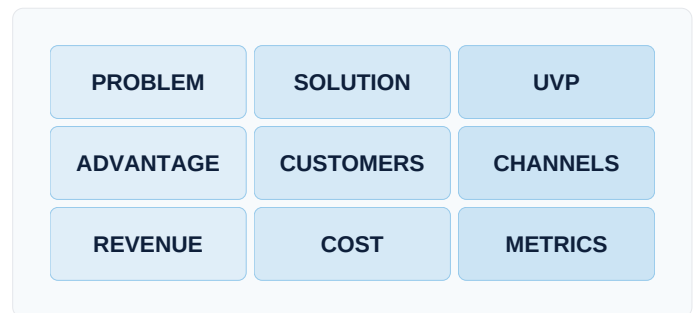


Figure 1. Lean Canvas replaces four BMC blocks with Problem, Solution, Metrics and Advantage. Adapted from Maurya (2012).

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Where Osterwalder's (2010) BMC was optimised for understanding existing businesses, Maurya's contribution is the early-stage adaptation that emphasises problem validation. Building on Steve Blank's (2005) customer-development methodology, the Lean Canvas became the dominant venture-design canvas of the 2010s.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

BMC 9 Blocks · Slibrary 9

Problem-Solution Fit · Slibrary 14

Product-Market Fit · Slibrary 14

Lean Stack · Slibrary 14

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Maurya, A. (2012) *Running Lean: Iterate from Plan A to a Plan That Works*. 2nd edn. Sebastopol: O'Reilly.

Osterwalder, A. and Pigneur, Y. (2010) *Business Model Generation*. Hoboken: Wiley.

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Blank, S. (2005) *The Four Steps to the Epiphany*. Pescadero, CA: K&S; Ranch.

Problem-Solution Fit

SLIBRARY 14 · SHEET 2 / 5

Have you solved a real problem for a real customer — before scaling

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

Problem-Solution Fit is the milestone at which a venture has demonstrably solved a real problem for a real customer segment with its current solution. The fit is binary in evidence: either specific customers are paying for, using, or actively requesting the solution, or they are not. Premature scaling without problem-solution fit produces well-engineered solutions to non-problems — a frequent and expensive failure mode that the milestone is engineered to prevent (Maurya, 2012; Blank, 2013).

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Articulated by Steve Blank in *The Four Steps to the Epiphany* (2005) and operationalised as a Lean Startup gate by Ash Maurya in *Running Lean* (2012). Distinct from but precedent to product-market fit (Andreessen, 2007).

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Founders raised capital and built engineering teams before validating they had a problem worth solving. Blank's customer-development sequence required problem-solution fit as the first gate, preventing the most common venture-failure mode — building well-engineered solutions to imagined problems.

HOW IT IS USED

Run discovery interviews to validate the problem. Test minimal solutions (concierge, smoke-test, MVP) to validate the solution addresses the problem. Customer behaviour — willingness to pay, use, or commit — is the only acceptable evidence; stated preference does not count.

WHEN IT IS USED

Use as a stage gate before any commitment to scale-team hiring, before any meaningful capital raise beyond seed, and as the diagnostic when a venture is uncertain whether to push forward or pivot.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Founders, accelerator coaches, seed-stage investors evaluating venture readiness, and MBA students learning the customer-development sequence.

FIGURE 1 · PROBLEM × SOLUTION

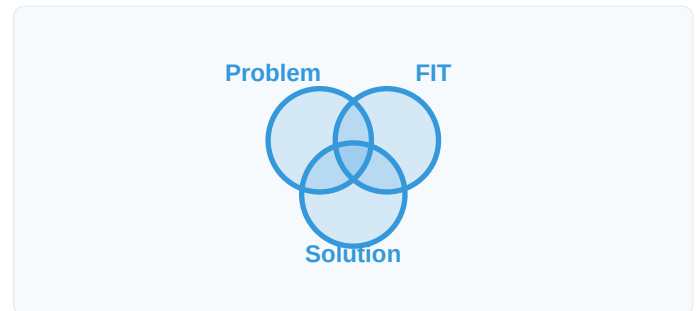


Figure 1. Problem-solution fit precedes product-market fit; without it, scale spends on unvalidated assumptions.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Where Cooper (1990) emphasised stage-gate processes for established firms and Drucker (1985) discussed entrepreneurship as opportunity-pursuit, Blank's contribution is the sequenced milestone framework where problem-solution fit precedes product-market fit. Building on Christensen's (1997) market-validation logic, it gives Lean Startup its discipline.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

Lean Canvas (9 Blocks) · Slibrary 14

Product-Market Fit · Slibrary 14

Discovery Interviews · Slibrary 16

Riskiest Assumption Test · Slibrary 15

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

- Maurya, A. (2012) *Running Lean*. 2nd edn. Sebastopol: O'Reilly.
 Blank, S. (2013) 'Why the Lean Start-Up Changes Everything', *Harvard Business Review*, 91(5), pp. 63–72.
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 Andreessen, M. (2007) 'The Only Thing That Matters', *pmarchive.com*.

Product-Market Fit

SLIBRARY 14 · SHEET 3 / 5

The moment when the market pulls harder than you push

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

Product-Market Fit (PMF) is the venture milestone at which the market actively pulls the product — through unsolicited demand, viral growth, customer retention and willingness to pay — rather than the team having to push it. Articulated by Andy Rachleff and Marc Andreessen, PMF is the dominant stage gate of modern venture practice: pre-PMF startups optimise for learning; post-PMF startups optimise for scale. The two playbooks are different in nearly every respect (Andreessen, 2007; Rachleff, 2014).

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Andy Rachleff (Benchmark Capital co-founder, Wealthfront founder) coined the term in lectures at Stanford GSB in the early 2000s; Marc Andreessen popularised it in his 2007 essay "The Only Thing That Matters". Sean Ellis (2009) operationalised the famous 40% test ("how disappointed would you be if this product disappeared?").

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Founders confused team conviction with market traction; investors needed an objective signal distinguishing the two. PMF provided it: when retention curves flatten, organic growth appears, and customers describe the product as essential, the market is pulling — and the strategy must shift from search to scale.

HOW IT IS USED

Measure cohort retention curves, organic-acquisition rate, NPS-style willingness-to-recommend, and Sean Ellis's 40% test. PMF is reached when these all show market pull simultaneously. Until then, the venture is in search mode.

WHEN IT IS USED

Use as the pivot signal between Lean Startup customer-development and full-scale company building. Track continuously through early-stage growth; PMF can be lost as well as gained.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Founders, venture-capital partners, growth teams, and accelerator programme directors. Standard milestone in seed-to-Series-A funding decisions.

FIGURE 1 · PUSH → PULL



Figure 1. Pre-PMF: optimise for learning. Post-PMF: optimise for scale. The transition changes everything.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Where Moore's (1991) chasm framework described market-segment progression and Rogers's (1962) diffusion-of-innovations curve explained adoption stages, Rachleff and Andreessen's contribution is the actionable startup-stage signal. Building on Blank's (2005) customer-development sequence, PMF became the dominant venture milestone.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

Problem-Solution Fit · Slibrary 14

Lean Canvas (9 Blocks) · Slibrary 14

AARRR · Pirate Metrics · Slibrary 16

Traction Canvas · Slibrary 14

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

- Andreessen, M. (2007) 'The Only Thing That Matters', *pmarchive.com*.
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 Ellis, S. (2009) *The Startup Pyramid*. Available at: startup-marketing.com.
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Lean Stack

SLIBRARY 14 · SHEET 4 / 5

Canvas → Experiments → Metrics → Learnings — one system

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The Lean Stack is Ash Maurya's integrated four-tool system for managing venture iteration: the *Canvas* (current model state), the *Experiments* (planned tests of risky assumptions), the *Metrics* (the data each experiment generates), and the *Learnings* (what each result teaches and what canvas-blocks must change). The stack converts the Lean Startup's loose principles into a closed-loop management system, making iteration auditable and progress measurable (Maurya, 2016).

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Ash Maurya, building on his Lean Canvas (2012), in *Scaling Lean* (2016). The stack was operationalised as a software product (Spark) supporting the four-layer workflow. Builds on Ries's (2011) Lean Startup loop and Blank's (2005) customer-development sequence.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Lean Startup teams generated experiments and learnings but lost the connections between them — an experiment's result rarely traced back to a specific canvas-block update. Maurya engineered the stack as a closed loop where every learning explicitly updates the canvas and informs the next experiment.

HOW IT IS USED

Maintain the four layers in sync: Canvas state, the next 1–3 experiments, the metrics each produces, and the learnings consolidated into canvas updates. Each experiment's learning loops back into the canvas before the next experiment is designed.

WHEN IT IS USED

Use in venture-design coaching, in accelerator-programme management, in corporate-innovation portfolio governance, and as the discipline behind Lean Startup execution at scale.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Founders running structured venture-design, accelerator-programme directors, corporate-innovation portfolio managers, and Lean Startup coaches.

FIGURE 1 · FOUR-LAYER STACK

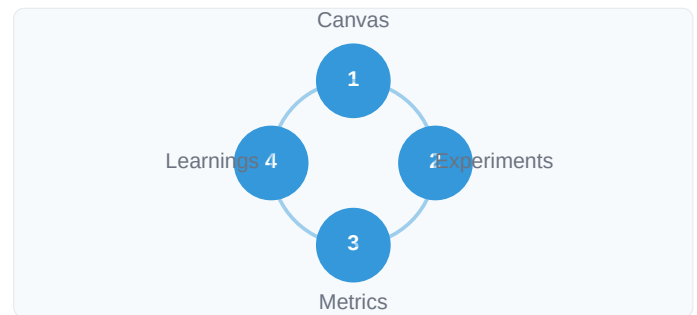


Figure 1. Each learning updates the canvas before the next experiment is designed; the loop closes auditably.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Where Ries's (2011) Build-Measure-Learn loop named the iteration cycle abstractly and Maurya's (2012) Lean Canvas captured static state, the Lean Stack's contribution is the integrated four-layer workflow that makes the loop auditable. Building on Deming's (1986) PDCA tradition, it gives venture iteration a management-systems form.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

Lean Canvas (9 Blocks) · Slibrary 14

Build-Measure-Learn · Slibrary 15

Riskiest Assumption Test · Slibrary 15

Validation Experiments · Slibrary 16

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

- Maurya, A. (2016) *Scaling Lean: Mastering the Key Metrics for Startup Growth*. New York: Portfolio.
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 Deming, W.E. (1986) *Out of the Crisis*. Cambridge, MA: MIT Press.

Traction Canvas

SLIBRARY 14 · SHEET 5 / 5

Define the metric that must grow — and the experiments that grow it

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The Traction Canvas (Weinberg and Mares, 2014) maps the venture's traction strategy across nineteen channels (viral marketing, PR, content, search, ads, etc.) and identifies the one or two channels currently most likely to deliver disproportionate growth. The canvas's discipline is forcing a single primary traction metric and a focused channel portfolio rather than spreading thin across all options — a venture-stage-specific tool for marketing-strategy clarity (Weinberg and Mares, 2014).

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Gabriel Weinberg (DuckDuckGo founder) and Justin Mares in *Traction* (2014). Builds on Andrew Chen's (2015) growth-channel research and Sean Ellis's (2010) growth-hacking methodology.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Early-stage founders defaulted to whichever marketing channel they personally understood — usually content or paid ads — missing channels with higher product-fit. Weinberg and Mares proposed the "Bullseye" framework: brainstorm all 19 channels, narrow to 3 to test, focus on the one that works.

FIGURE 1 · BULLSEYE METHOD

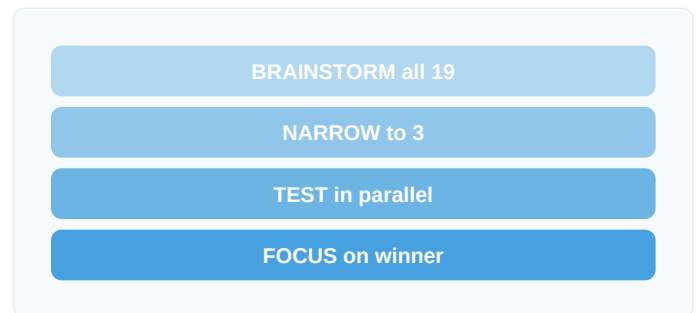


Figure 1. Most ventures default to one channel; the Bullseye method forces multi-channel testing then sharp focus.

HOW IT IS USED

Inventory all 19 traction channels. Brainstorm tactics for each. Narrow to 3 to test in parallel with small budgets. Pick the one delivering the highest cost-effective growth and double down. Revisit when growth flattens.

WHEN IT IS USED

Use after problem-solution fit, in early growth-strategy design, when marketing budgets are unfocused, and when transitioning from product-build to growth modes.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Founders, growth marketers, accelerator coaches advising on go-to-market, and venture-capital advisors helping portfolio companies focus channel investment.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Where Kotler (2003) catalogued marketing-mix elements abstractly and growth-hacking literature (Ellis, 2010) emphasised tactics, Weinberg and Mares's contribution is the channel-portfolio discipline — explicit testing of multiple channels with structured down-selection. Building on Christensen's (1997) market-segmentation logic, it gives early-stage growth a focusing tool.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

Lean Canvas (9 Blocks) · Slibrary 14

AARRR · Pirate Metrics · Slibrary 16

Validation Experiments · Slibrary 16

Product-Market Fit · Slibrary 14

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Weinberg, G. and Mares, J. (2014) *Traction: How Any Startup Can Achieve Explosive Customer Growth*. New York: Portfolio.
 Ellis, S. (2010) 'Find a Growth Hacker for Your Startup', *startup-marketing.com*.
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Kano Model

SLIBRARY 15 · SHEET 1 / 5

Must-haves · Performance · Delighters — three feature kinds

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

Noriaki Kano's quality model classifies product features into three categories with different satisfaction dynamics: *Must-haves* (basic expectations whose absence causes dissatisfaction but whose presence is unnoticed), *Performance* features (linear: more is better), and *Delighters* (unexpected features producing delight). Two further categories — Indifferent and Reverse — capture features that don't matter or actively harm. The model prescribes different design strategies for each category (Kano, 1984).

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Noriaki Kano, professor at Tokyo University of Science, in his 1984 paper for the Japanese Society for Quality Control. Translated into Western quality literature in the 1990s through TQM and lean manufacturing channels.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Quality measurement treated all features equivalently — adding more features was assumed to raise satisfaction proportionally. Kano's research showed satisfaction was non-linear: must-haves had threshold effects, performance was linear, delighters were exponential and decayed over time as they became expected.

HOW IT IS USED

Survey customers using Kano's two-question format (functional and dysfunctional questions) for each feature. Classify features into the five categories. Allocate development effort: must-haves get parity investment, performance gets linear investment, delighters get strategic investment.

WHEN IT IS USED

Use in feature-prioritisation workshops, in roadmap planning, in MVP scoping, and as a check against treating all features equally in product backlogs.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Product managers, UX researchers, quality leaders, and consultants advising on feature-portfolio strategy. Standard tool in lean and TQM training programmes.

FIGURE 1 · THREE FEATURE KINDS

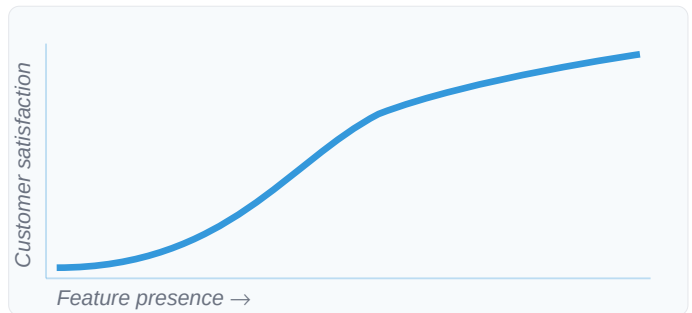


Figure 1. Must-haves have threshold; performance is linear; delighters are exponential and decay over time.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Where Maslow's (1954) hierarchy classified human needs and Herzberg's (1959) two-factor theory distinguished hygiene from motivators, Kano's contribution is the equivalent for product features — non-linear, time-decaying, and operationally measurable. Building on quality-management traditions (Deming, 1986), it gave feature-strategy a categorical grammar.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

MVP Ladder · Slibrary 15

Outcome-Driven Innovation · Slibrary 13

Build-Measure-Learn · Slibrary 15

Value Proposition Canvas · Slibrary 9

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

- Kano, N. (1984) 'Attractive Quality and Must-Be Quality', *Journal of the Japanese Society for Quality Control*, 14(2), pp. 39–48.
- Berger, C. et al. (1993) 'Kano's Methods for Understanding Customer-Defined Quality', *Center for Quality Management Journal*, 2(4), pp. 3–35.
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MVP Ladder

SLIBRARY 15 · SHEET 2 / 5

Concierge → Wizard of Oz → Prototype → Product

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The MVP Ladder is a progression of increasingly sophisticated minimum-viable-product formats, each buying more learning per build dollar: *Concierge* (deliver the service manually for a small group), *Wizard of Oz* (look automated, work manually behind the scenes), *Prototype* (functional stand-in with shortcuts), and *Product* (real automation). Climbing the ladder one rung at a time prevents premature investment in automation before the value proposition is validated (Maurya, 2012; Ries, 2011).

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Synthesised from multiple Lean Startup practitioners; the Concierge MVP and Wizard-of-Oz patterns are described in Eric Ries's *The Lean Startup* (2011); the ladder formulation is articulated by Ash Maurya in *Running Lean* (2012) and Frank Robinson's MVP literature (2001).

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Founders defaulted to building Product MVPs that required automation, code and infrastructure — burning months before learning whether the value proposition worked. The ladder showed that earlier rungs delivered the same learning at fractional cost.

HOW IT IS USED

Start at the lowest rung that produces real customer behaviour for the value hypothesis. Climb only when learning at the current rung is exhausted. The discipline prevents over-investment in automation before the value question is settled.

WHEN IT IS USED

Use in venture-inception MVP planning, in feature-validation sprints, in corporate-innovation labs, and whenever the team is tempted to build automation before validating value.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Founders, lean-startup coaches, accelerator programme directors, and corporate-innovation labs validating new offers before scale-build commitments.

FIGURE 1 · FOUR RUNGS



Figure 1. Each rung buys more learning per build dollar; climbing prematurely wastes months.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Where Robinson (2001) coined the MVP term abstractly and Ries (2011) operationalised it as the Lean Startup's centerpiece, the ladder formulation's contribution is the explicit progression — each rung specified, each transition rule clarified. Building on Beck's (1999) extreme-programming spike-tests tradition, it gives MVP design a teachable hierarchy.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

Build-Measure-Learn · Slibrary 15

Pretotyping · Slibrary 15

Riskiest Assumption Test · Slibrary 15

Lean Canvas (9 Blocks) · Slibrary 14

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Maurya, A. (2012) *Running Lean*. 2nd edn. Sebastopol: O'Reilly.

Ries, E. (2011) *The Lean Startup*. New York: Crown Business.

Robinson, F. (2001) 'Minimum Viable Product', *SyncDev*.

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Build-Measure-Learn

SLIBRARY 15 · SHEET 3 / 5

Code · Data · Insight — speed through the loop is the metric

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

Eric Ries's Build-Measure-Learn loop is the Lean Startup's central operating cycle: build a minimum experiment, measure customer behaviour against the hypothesis, extract validated learning, and feed that learning into the next build. The loop's only optimisation target is cycle time — the speed through one full revolution determines learning velocity, which determines venture survival under uncertainty. Everything else in Lean Startup serves the loop (Ries, 2011).

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Eric Ries, founder and Lean Startup methodology author, in his 2011 book *The Lean Startup*. Built on Steve Blank's customer-development sequence (2005) and applied Toyota Production System principles (Ohno, 1988) to startup contexts.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Conventional product development optimised the build phase (writing code, designing) at the expense of the learn phase. Ries argued under genuine uncertainty the limiting factor was learning velocity — and that the entire methodology should optimise the loop, not its individual steps.

HOW IT IS USED

Define a hypothesis. Build the minimum experiment that tests it. Measure customer behaviour (not opinion). Extract the validated learning. Update the canvas and choose the next hypothesis. Optimise loop cycle time relentlessly.

WHEN IT IS USED

Use as the operating cadence of any Lean Startup-style venture, in corporate innovation labs, in product-discovery teams, and as the meta-discipline behind agile development under uncertainty.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Founders, agile coaches, product managers, corporate-innovation leaders, and consultants advising on innovation-portfolio velocity.

FIGURE 1 · THREE-PHASE LOOP

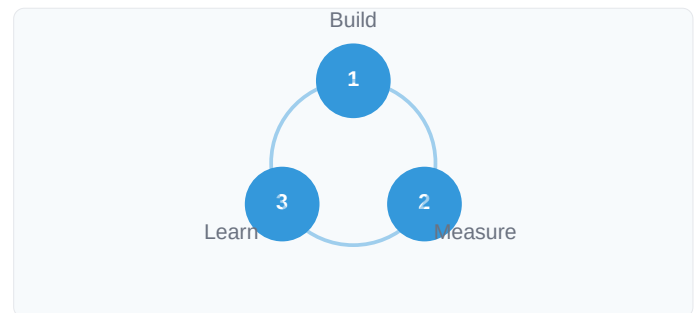


Figure 1. Cycle time is the only optimisation target. Faster loops compound; slow loops bankrupt.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Where Deming's (1986) PDCA cycle was a manufacturing loop and Toyota's (Ohno, 1988) takt-time discipline applied to assembly, Ries's contribution is the cycle's adaptation to startup uncertainty — where the unit of optimisation is validated learning, not produced units. Building on Blank's (2005) customer-development sequence, it became the dominant innovation operating model.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

MVP Ladder · Slibrary 15

Riskiest Assumption Test · Slibrary 15

Lean Stack · Slibrary 14

Sprint Retrospective · Slibrary 6

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

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Riskiest Assumption Test

SLIBRARY 15 · SHEET 4 / 5

Find the assumption that kills the idea — test it first, cheap and fast

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The Riskiest Assumption Test (RAT) reframes MVP design from "what minimum thing do we build?" to "what most-likely-to-be-wrong belief sinks the venture if proven false?". Each candidate venture has a hierarchy of assumptions (problem exists, customers will pay, channel works, retention happens); the RAT discipline isolates the riskiest, designs the cheapest test that genuinely interrogates it, and runs it before any other build (Bland and Osterwalder, 2019; Maurya, 2012).

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Operationalised by David Bland and Alexander Osterwalder in *Testing Business Ideas* (2019), drawing on Maurya's (2012) Lean Startup risk taxonomy and Eric Ries's (2011) leap-of-faith assumptions concept.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Founders built MVPs that tested whichever assumption was easiest, leaving riskier assumptions untested until expensive build had committed to them. The RAT discipline inverts the order — test what could most cheaply kill the venture first, before anything else.

FIGURE 1 · RISK × UNCERTAINTY

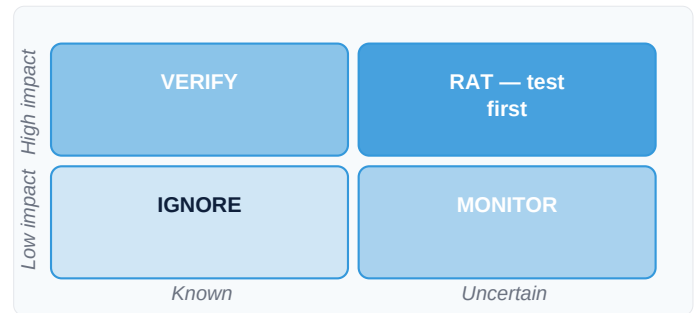


Figure 1. The riskiest assumption — high impact × high uncertainty — is tested first; everything else waits.

HOW IT IS USED

List all venture assumptions. Rank by risk (consequence of being wrong) and uncertainty (current evidence). The highest-risk × highest-uncertainty assumption is the RAT. Design the cheapest experiment that genuinely tests it; run it before any other build.

WHEN IT IS USED

Use in venture-inception MVP planning, in pivot decisions, in stage-gate reviews, and whenever a team is about to commit significant build effort under uncertainty.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Founders, lean-startup coaches, accelerator directors, venture-capital partners advising portfolio companies, and corporate-innovation portfolio managers.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Where Ries (2011) named leap-of-faith assumptions and Maurya (2012) ranked them, Bland and Osterwalder's contribution is the systematic test-design library mapping assumption types to specific experiments. Building on Christensen's (2003) discovery-driven planning, it gives MVP design a risk-prioritisation discipline.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

MVP Ladder · Slibrary 15

Build-Measure-Learn · Slibrary 15

Pre-Mortem · Slibrary 11

Validation Experiments · Slibrary 16

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Bland, D.J. and Osterwalder, A. (2019) *Testing Business Ideas*. Hoboken: Wiley.

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Pretotyping

SLIBRARY 15 · SHEET 5 / 5

Savoia — *fake it before you make it*

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

Alberto Savoia's pretotyping ("fake it before you make it") is the practice of building the *appearance* of a product before the product — gauging real demand with smoke-tests, fake-door pages, mock-ups and Mechanical Turk-style manual fulfilment before any real engineering commitment. The data on whether real users behave as predicted is the only evidence that justifies build investment; pretotyping makes that data cheap to collect (Savoia, 2011, 2019).

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Alberto Savoia, former Google engineering director, in *Pretotype It* (2011) and *The Right It* (2019). Built on Savoia's experience launching products at Google where most failed despite being well-built — usually because nobody wanted them.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Most new products fail not because they are built poorly but because nobody wants them. Savoia argued that the entire problem is the wrong problem if the build comes before the want-test. Pretotyping engineered the want-test to come first, at fractional cost.

HOW IT IS USED

Pick a pretotyping pattern matched to the product type — fake door (landing page with click-through metric), Mechanical Turk (humans simulating the product), 8-bit (low-fi version), pinocchio (non-functional model). Measure real behaviour against an explicit demand threshold before building.

WHEN IT IS USED

Use before any product commitment, in venture-inception experimentation, in feature-prioritisation triage, and in corporate-innovation portfolio screens.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Founders, product managers, corporate-innovation labs, accelerator coaches, and venture-capital partners assessing whether portfolio companies have real demand evidence.

FIGURE 1 · FAKE → REAL

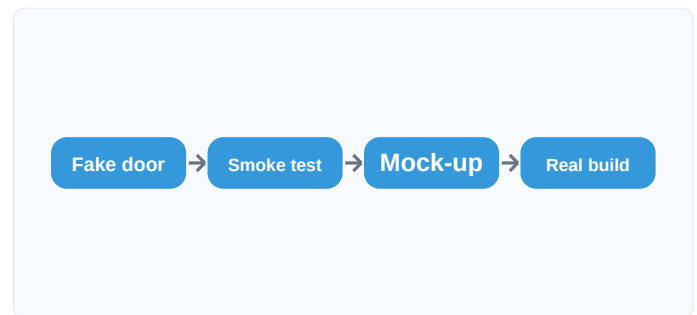


Figure 1. Real behaviour against fake products is the cheapest evidence for the want-test. Build comes after.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Where Ries's (2011) MVP was a real but minimal product and Wizard-of-Oz tests faked back-end automation, Savoia's contribution is the explicit pre-product-build evidence discipline. Building on Toyota's *genchi genbutsu* (Liker, 2004) and Lean Startup heritage, pretotyping makes want-validation a separable, faster, cheaper step.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

MVP Ladder · Slibrary 15

Riskiest Assumption Test · Slibrary 15

Build-Measure-Learn · Slibrary 15

Validation Experiments · Slibrary 16

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

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